



ICI Consulting

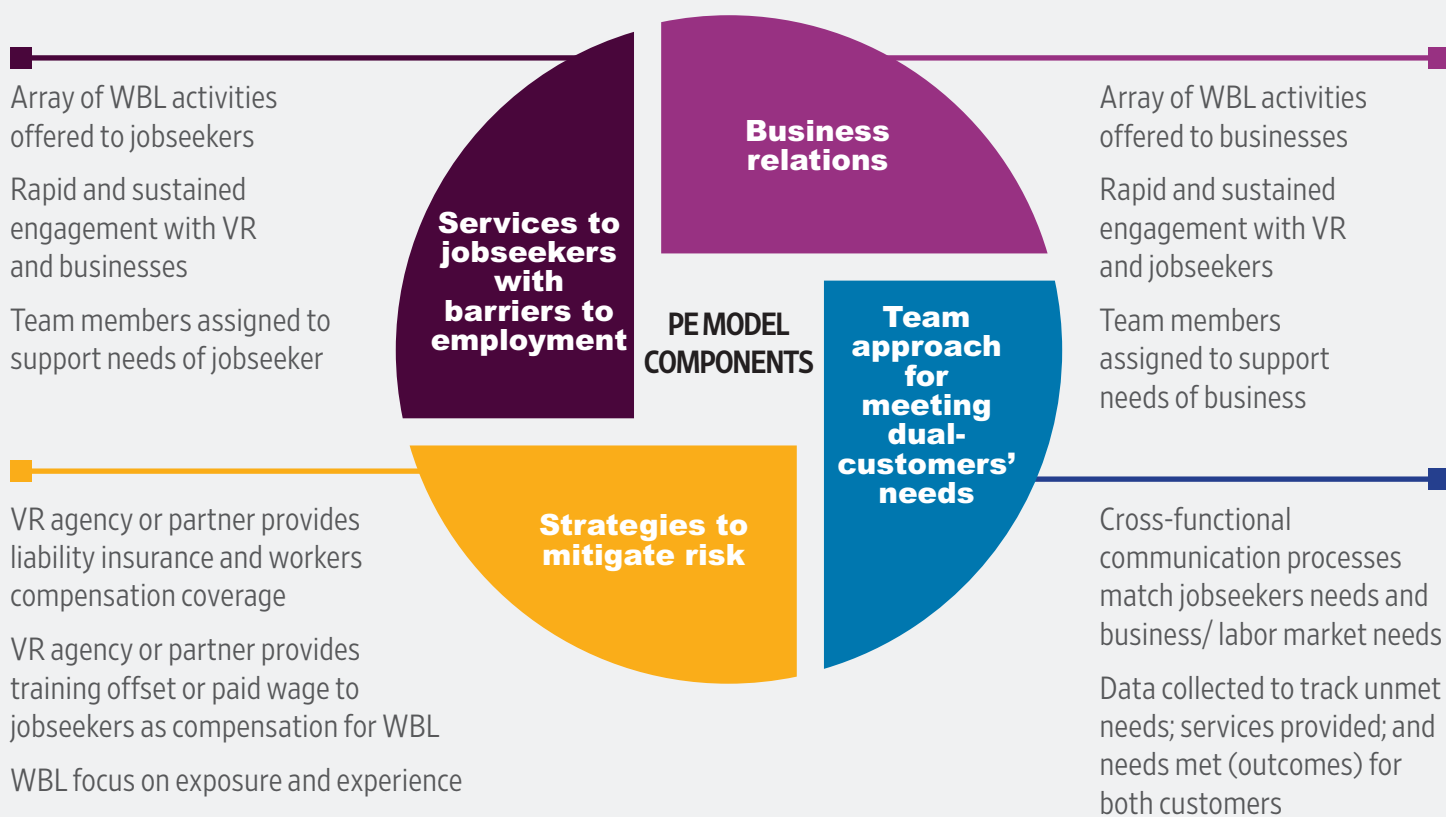
Progressive Employment



What We Offer Your Agency

WHAT IS THE PROGRESSIVE EMPLOYMENT (PE) MODEL?

The PE model is a dual-customer, team-based approach that uses work-based learning (WBL) strategies to meet the needs of businesses and job seekers with barriers to employment. In this model, a vocational rehabilitation (VR) agency and partnering employment service providers coordinate the match between employer/employee and take on the risk for both parties.



WHAT ARE THE EMPLOYMENT OUTCOMES?

Since its inception in 2009, the PE Model has been defined, extracted from Vermont DVR (Moore et al., 2018) and replicated in agencies with different structures, policies, and cultures with fidelity to key components. The Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI) has been conducting research, training and technical assistance, and evaluation of the model in partnership with Vermont and VR agencies in Maine, Nebraska, and Oregon.

In 2019, the total number of job seekers receiving PE in Vermont, Nebraska, Maine, and Oregon was over 4,300. In the three replication states outside of Vermont, **nearly 500 of the 2,000 jobseekers in PE have closed into competitive integrated employment** since 2016.

In Vermont, data from May 2009 to July 2016 identified a total of 2,395 VR job seekers who participated in PE. The rehabilitation rate (successful job placement after the individualized plan

for employment or IPE) for PE was 62%. **That's five percentage points higher than the agency-wide rehabilitation rate of 57% for this entire time period¹.** Researchers have also found that PE increases the likelihood of employment for VR clients in Vermont by over 20 percentage point².

ICI researchers are currently exploring outcome differentials for PE vs. non-PE cases in Maine and Nebraska for both youth and adults. Preliminary indicators show higher rates of successful employment outcomes for individuals receiving PE in Nebraska³ and fewer drop-outs from VR (cases exiting VR before IPE) for youth in Maine⁴.

The ICI's goal is to continue to build an evidence base for the PE model, given these promising findings to date.

WHAT PE RESOURCES ARE AVAILABLE?

Visit the ICI's webpage at www.explorevr.org/content/vermont-progressive-employment-model to find more information about PE. Our resources include:

- » **Video series:** Job seekers, businesses, and VR agency personnel in Vermont and Maine describe their experiences and success with the PE model.
- » **Working papers and articles:** These detail the model replication and outcomes to date for Nebraska, Maine, and Oregon. A paper describing the evolution and key model components was also published in the Journal of Vocational Rehabilitation.
- » **Webinars and conference presentations:** Archived webinars about the PE model and conference presentation materials, including the 2019 Program Evaluation and Quality Assurance presentation on the PE model.
- » **VR agency PE profiles:** Engaging presentations about PE adoption and adaptation across state agencies and community rehabilitation providers.
- » **Podcasts:** Maine's VR agency director talks about PE for youth.
- » **Other research reports:** Mathematica Policy Research's preliminary impact analysis brief highlights PE outcomes in Vermont.

WANT TO LEARN MORE?

The ICI offers a tiered consulting package to state agencies interested in implementing the PE model. Beginning with a pre-adoption information and assessment phase, we will provide "PE 101" resources in multiple formats (videos, reports, tailored case examples). We will also connect you with other state agency leaders and personnel currently using PE and invite you to attend a PE Learning Collaborative meeting as a guest.

ICI expert consultants will work with your agency leadership to discuss how this model can help improve employment outcomes for the job seekers and businesses you serve, and to think through the resources and capacity needed to implement the PE model at your agency and measure results.

References

- ¹ Moore, D., Haines, K., Bradshaw, H., Porter, A., Smith, J., & Foley, S. (2018). Development of the Progressive Employment dual customer model for vocational rehabilitation. *Journal of Vocational Rehabilitation*, 49, 149–160.
- ² Mann, D., Stapleton, D., and Porter, A. (2018, September). Vermont's Progressive Employment Program: A Preliminary Impact Analysis. Mathematic Policy Research. Retrieved from: www.mathematica.org/our-publications-and-findings/publications/vermonts-progressive-employment-program-a-preliminary-impact-analysis
- ³ Moore, D., Haines, K., Foley, S., Kwan, N. (2020, May). Nebraska Vocational Rehabilitation Progressive Employment Model Replication and Evaluation Report: 2019-2020 Update. Working Paper, Version 2. Boston, MA: University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.
- ⁴ Moore, D., Haines, K., Foley, S., Kwan, N., Mitchell, D. (May 2018). Maine Division of Vocational Rehabilitation Progressive Employment Model Replication and Evaluation Report: Working Paper, Version 1. Boston, MA: University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.

About ICI Consulting

ICI is nationally recognized for our research, technical assistance, training, and project development in the field of disability. Through ICI Consulting Services, you can access the full breadth and scope of our expertise. We tailor our resources to meet the needs of organizations like yours, so you can grow, thrive, and measure your progress.

About Explore VR

ExploreVR offers VR agencies easy and convenient access to a range of VR research, related data, training and tools for planning, evaluation, and decision-making.

For more information

Kelly Haines
Institute for Community Inclusion
University of Massachusetts Boston
kelly.haines@umb.edu

